

Optional Subject Strategy Overview

How optional choice and preparation multiply total Mains score.

Portion focus ~35% · Topic: opt-overview

PYQ themes: Optional strategy

Why UPSC asks this

Optional is 500 marks — strategic leverage.

Choice

Interest, background, scoring trends (cautiously), material availability.

Prep

Syllabus micro-notes; PYQ mapping; answer writing weekly.

Must remember

- Overlap with GS; availability of guidance; interest sustainability
- PYQ-driven notes > blind reading

Educational prioritisation heuristic — not an official UPSC prediction. © UPSC IAS Study Hub original notes.